

AI TOOLS THAT WORK

Summarize It, Then Check It

A real NASA article about leap seconds, a 3-sentence summary, and a line-by-line check.

Tested October 4, 2026

Why this guide

You have a long article and ten minutes. An AI chat can give you a short summary. But a summary is a set of claims, and each sentence is something the article may or may not say.

So I asked for a 3-sentence summary and checked every sentence against the article. Then I asked a few questions, one of which the article cannot answer.

The article and the AI answers are real.

How I tested

I used a free public chat demo, with no account and no payment: the Qwen3 demo on Hugging Face

(huggingface.co/spaces/Qwen/Qwen3-Demo), model shown as Qwen3-235B-A22B.

The article is "NASA Explains Why June 30 Will Get Extra Second" by Katy Mersmann, dated June 26, 2015. I read it on October 4, 2026 at 12:19 PM Saudi time and ran two chats at 12:23 PM. One run each, so another run can answer differently.

The article is from 2015. It says nothing about leap seconds after that date, and I make no claim about how leap seconds work or are planned today.

I pasted about half the article. I dropped some sentences inside paragraphs, such as the part about quasars, and kept the wording of the rest.

My first attempt showed "Connection errored out" in the demo. I reloaded the page and ran it again. The run shown is the second.

PART 1

The summary

I asked for exactly 3 short sentences for a friend who has never heard of leap seconds.

ANSWER, 8.5 SECONDS

On June 30, 2015, an extra "leap second" was added to account for Earth's gradually slowing rotation, which causes a tiny but cumulative mismatch between atomic time (UTC) and the solar day. While UTC uses precise atomic clocks, Earth's rotation adds about 2 milliseconds per day, leading to a nearly one-second drift annually if uncorrected. Leap seconds are inserted irregularly—typically on June 30 or December 31—to keep the two time systems within 0.9 seconds of each other, though they can disrupt computer systems due to unpredictable scheduling.

What it got right

- Three sentences, as asked. The 0.9 second limit, the June 30 or December 31 timing and the computer problems all match the article.
- It says leap seconds are added because Earth's rotation is slowing. The article says so.

What needed fixing

- I asked for "short sentences" and got three long ones. Ask for a word limit too, such as 20 words each.
- "Adds about 2 milliseconds per day, leading to a nearly one-second drift annually if uncorrected." The article gives the 2 milliseconds and the almost-a-second figure, but warns it is not quite what happens because each day varies. The summary drops that warning.
- "An extra leap second was added." The article was written before it happened ("will be added"). Small, but a date matters in a summary.

PART 2

Questions from the text

ANSWERS, 8.0 SECONDS

Leap seconds exist to account for Earth's gradually slowing rotation, keeping Coordinated Universal Time (UTC) within 0.9 seconds of the mean solar day.

Between 1972 and 1999, leap seconds were added at a rate averaging close to one per year.

Not in the text.

What it got right

- Question 1 matches the article. Question 2 matches: close to one per year, 1972 to 1999.
- Question 3 was the trap: how many leap seconds in the year after. The article does not say. It wrote "Not in the text".

What needed fixing

- Answer 1 says UTC is kept within 0.9 seconds of "the mean solar day". The article says the other time standard is UT1, which is based on Earth's rotation. Close, but not the same term. Check the exact word when it matters.

Lesson: for a summary, find each sentence in the source. If you cannot find it, cross it out.

What I took from this

The summary was good and still dropped a caveat. That is the usual weak spot, so check the "but".

1. Did it keep to your length?
2. Find each claim in the article.
3. Did it drop a "but" or a "not quite"?
4. Is the tense right for the date?
5. Did it say "Not in the text" for the trap?

The prompts

Where the article goes, it says [PASTE THE TEXT HERE]. Put your own text there.

PROMPT 1: SUMMARY

Below is an excerpt from a NASA article. Summarize it in exactly 3 short sentences for a friend who has never heard of leap seconds. Use only the text. Plain text only.

TEXT:

[PASTE THE TEXT HERE: the excerpt shown in the example above]

PROMPT 2: QUESTIONS

Below is an excerpt from a NASA article. Answer ONLY from the text. If the text does not say, write "Not in the text". Plain text only. Answer each question in one or two lines.

TEXT:

[PASTE THE TEXT HERE: the excerpt shown in the example above]

QUESTIONS:

1. Why do leap seconds exist?
2. Between 1972 and 1999, about how often were leap seconds added?
3. How many leap seconds will be added in the year after the one in this article?

Limits and sources

- One public demo model, one day, one run per prompt. Another run or tool can answer differently, including wrongly.
- The article is from 2015. I make no claim about today.
- The pasted text is partial and slightly trimmed, as explained above.

SOURCES

NASA, Katy Mersmann, "NASA Explains Why June 30 Will Get Extra Second", June 26, 2015: nasa.gov/centers-and-facilities/goddard/nasa-explains-why-june-30-will-get-extra-second/ (read October 4, 2026)

Qwen3 demo:

huggingface.co/spaces/Qwen/Qwen3-Demo

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